BANQUET HALL BOOKING SYSTEM

Smart Venue Reservation & Event Management Platform

Phase 2 — Ideation Phase | Date: 31 January 2025 | Maximum Marks: 10

2.1 Problem Statement

Traditional banquet hall booking involves time-consuming manual processes such as phone calls, in-person visits, and paper-based records. Clients face difficulties in finding available halls, comparing pricing, and confirming event details. Venue managers struggle with scheduling conflicts, payment tracking, and client communication. There is a critical need for a unified, digital-first solution that simplifies the entire booking lifecycle.

Core Challenges Identified

C1	No centralized digital platform for discovering and comparing banquet halls in real-time.
C2	Manual scheduling leads to double bookings, cancellations, and revenue loss for venues.
C3	Clients lack transparency in pricing, package inclusions, and availability status.
C4	Communication gaps between clients and hall management delay event planning.

Customer Problem Statements

Using the Customer Problem Statement framework, the following statements were developed to articulate user pain points:

PS #	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	A wedding client	book a hall 3 months in advance	I can't check real-time availability online	Venues lack digital systems	Anxious and frustrated

PS-2	A venue manager	manage multiple event bookings efficiently	double bookings occur frequently	No automated conflict detection	Overwhelmed and stressed

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

The Empathy Map was constructed by interviewing prospective clients and venue managers to understand their experiences and frustrations with current booking processes. The map captures what users Say, Think, Do, and Feel, along with their Pains and Gains.

User Persona: Event Planner / Wedding Client

SAYS

"I wish I could check availability without calling."

"I need clear pricing upfront, not hidden costs."

"Why can't I just book online like a hotel?"

THINKS

"Will my booking actually be confirmed?"

"What if the hall is already taken on my date?"

"I should compare more options before deciding."

DOES

Visits multiple halls in person and compares manually

Calls venues repeatedly for availability updates

Relies on spreadsheets or notes to track options

FEELS

Frustrated by lack of digital information

Anxious about planning uncertainty and deadlines

Overwhelmed by the number of decisions to make

PAIN

- Hard to find hall matching specific requirements
- Uncomfortable making large payments without trust signals
- Lack of transparent pricing leads to budget uncertainty

GAIN

- Quick discovery of available halls by date & capacity
- Transparent pricing with instant quotes
- Confidence from verified reviews and secure payments

2.3 Brainstorming & Idea Prioritization

The team conducted structured brainstorming sessions using the 'How Might We' framework and affinity mapping. Ideas were generated, grouped by theme, and prioritized based on importance vs. feasibility.

How Might We (HMW) Problem Frame

> *"How might we help clients discover, compare, and book banquet halls online in real-time, while giving venue managers full control over their scheduling and revenue?"*

Brainstormed Ideas

Idea 1	Build a smart search engine that filters halls by date, capacity, location, and price range.
Idea 2	Implement an interactive calendar for each venue showing live availability and blocked dates.
Idea 3	Provide a virtual tour or gallery feature so clients can preview the hall without visiting.
Idea 4	Enable digital contract signing and instant payment gateway integration for seamless transactions.
Idea 5	Create a dashboard for venue managers to track bookings, revenue, and client communications.
Idea 6	Introduce a review and rating system to build trust between clients and venues.
Idea 7	Add automated email/SMS notifications for booking confirmations, reminders, and updates.
Idea 8	Develop a comparison tool so clients can view up to 3 venues side by side.

Idea Prioritization Matrix

Ideas were evaluated on two dimensions — Importance (impact if implemented) and Feasibility (ease of implementation given current resources and timeline).

	Low Feasibility	**Medium Feasibility**	**High Feasibility**
Low Importance	Idea 8 (Comparison tool)	Idea 6 (Reviews)	—

□ **Medium Importance**	Idea 3 (Virtual tour)	Idea 7 (Notifications)	Idea 5 (Manager dashboard)
□ **High Importance**	—	Idea 4 (Payments)	**Idea 1 (Search) ★ Idea 2 (Calendar) ★**

★ Top Priority: Idea 1 (Smart Search Engine) and Idea 2 (Interactive Availability Calendar) were selected as the highest-priority features for the initial development sprint, as they are both highly important and highly feasible given the existing technology stack.